Communication Plan Template · Expert version

A communication plan template sets out who needs what information, when, how and from whom, so stakeholders stay informed without drowning in updates.

How to use this template

1. List your stakeholders and what each needs to know (start from your stakeholder register).
2. Define each communication's purpose and content.
3. Choose the channel, frequency and format that suit each audience.
4. Assign an owner for every communication.
5. Agree how people give feedback, and review the plan at each phase.

Tips

• Tailor detail to the audience: executives want decisions and risks.
• Fewer, regular updates beat many ad hoc ones.
• Check people actually read them.
• Pair it with a RACI matrix.

Dashboard (sample data)

Field	Value	Count
Owner	Comms lead	1
Owner	Marketing	1
Owner	Project manager	1
Owner	Sponsor	1
Owner	Team lead	1

Communication plan · Who needs what, when, how and from whom

Communication	Audience	Purpose / content	Channel	Frequency	Owner	Format	Feedback route
Status report	Sponsor, steering group	Progress, RAG status, risks, decisions needed	Email + dashboard	Weekly	Project manager	1-page report	Reply or steering meeting
Steering committee	Steering group	Decisions, escalations, budget	Meeting	Monthly	Sponsor	Slides	Minutes and actions
Team stand-up	Project team	Today's work and blockers	Video call	Daily	Team lead	15-minute meeting	In the meeting
Stakeholder newsletter	Wider organisation	What's changing and when	Intranet	Monthly	Comms lead	Article	Comments
Go-live notice	Customers	New features and support	Email	Once	Marketing	Email	Support inbox